suggesting that in spite of a lack of familiarity with surveys and reserve, Myanmar citizens were eager to share their views. The only area in the Myanmar ABS where there was more reserve was in voting intentions.[8]

A word of caution is also necessary about the interpretation of the results. Survey methodology is limited by the wording of questions. Care was taken in the pilot and pre-tests to work toward comprehension and conceptual clarity in the survey wording in Burmese, moving into more colloquial and accessible vocabulary. Nevertheless, analysis of the findings cannot account for the varied meanings of words and potential multiple (mis)understandings of concepts. Below, the findings are presented with limited speculation on alternative and varied meanings, recognizing that alternative methodologies such as focus groups and ethnography provide more in-depth understandings of terms and their meanings.

CONFLICT-AVERSION AND RECOGNITION

We begin with the findings on how the Myanmar public views conflict. One of the interesting findings of the Myanmar ABS involves political culture, as the ABS shows that Myanmar respondents record the most conservative views among the Southeast Asian countries surveyed. This conservatism extends to how they perceive conflict; Myanmar citizens indicate in the ABS that they are highly conflict-averse.

As part of the political culture battery in the ABS, we ask a series of questions about conflict. Respondents are asked to agree or disagree with the following statements: "Even if there is some disagreement with others, one should avoid the conflict"; "In a group, we should avoid open quarrel to preserve the harmony of the group"; "A person should not insist on his own opinion if his co-workers disagree with him". These questions allow us to understand how individuals view conflict at an individual level. The consistent picture emerging is that Myanmar citizens report that conflict should be avoided. A large majority of the people surveyed (ninety-nine per cent) believe that one should avoid conflict, with eighty-eight per cent and ninety-four per cent expressing similar views with regard to the need to preserve harmony and not insisting on one's views. To put these findings in perspective, Figure 13.1 shows where the Myanmar public stands on conflict avoidance compared to other countries in Southeast Asia, revealing that Myanmar citizens profess a desire to avoid conflict at the individual